

Carlos A. Silva

Environmental Economist

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[Website](#) - [Google Scholar](#)

PROFILE

Environmental economist whose research and teaching focus on sustainable development, environmental policy and socio-ecological systems. With research and professional experience in the Latin American context, my work combines economics, public policy and conservation science to address complex sustainability challenges through interdisciplinary research. Besides an active research agenda, I have experience teaching undergraduate, MBA and postgraduate students using student-centred and research-led approaches, with a strong commitment to inclusive, engaging and evidence-informed higher education.

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Environmental Economics; Sustainable Development; Environmental Policy; Behavioural Environmental Economics; Non-market Valuation; Applied Econometrics; Public Policy; Fisheries and Biodiversity Conservation

EDUCATION

PhD Economics (expected Sep-Dec 2026), Heriot-Watt University

Thesis: Public acceptability and economic valuation of sustainable development policies

Supervisors: Claudia Aravena, Eoin McLaughlin

MSc Econometrics and Economics, University of York

Bachelor of Economics, ESPOL Polytechnic University

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Edinburgh Business School – Heriot-Watt University (2024-2025)

- Delivered undergraduate tutorials for the Contemporary Economic Policy and Institutions module.
- Designed seminar activities to reinforce key concepts in economic policy and institutions.
- Contributed to assessment and marking, providing constructive feedback to students.
- Supported interdisciplinary learning through discussion and problem-solving activities.

ESPAE Business School - ESPOL Polytechnic University (2019-2020)

- Delivered tutorials in microeconomics for MBA students covering market equilibrium, taxation and industrial organisation.

- Designed lectures, seminar activities and assessments in collaboration with the module lecturer, using case-based learning approaches and Harvard Business School case studies.
- Taught diverse cohorts of postgraduate students from a range of professional backgrounds through face-to-face and online learning environments.
- Marked coursework and examinations and provided individual academic guidance on MBA projects.

Teaching Assistant ESPOL Polytechnic University 2014-2015

- Tutorials and support on exam designing and exam marking for Econometrics I and II.

Teaching and Professional Development

Heriot-Watt University – Learning and Teaching Academy (2024)

- Completed courses in the In at the Deep End programme for new university teachers.
- Undertook professional development in small- and large-group teaching, active learning, assessment and feedback, student engagement and evidence-informed teaching practice.
- Participated in facilitated workshops with peers and completed self-directed training through the University's teaching development programme.

RESEARCH EMPLOYMENT

Environmental Economist

Charles Darwin Foundation, 2020–Present

- Led economic valuation studies of ecosystem services and marine conservation policies using stated preference methods.
- Contributed socio-economic analysis to interdisciplinary conservation, ecosystem accounting, and fisheries modelling studies.
- Designed and implemented stakeholder fieldwork across fisheries and tourism sectors in Ecuador.
- Advised policymakers on marine zoning redesign and fisheries closures.
- Secured research funding and contributed to develop interdisciplinary project grant proposals.
- Designed and delivered capacity-building workshops on sustainable business models for community organisations, local stakeholders and public authorities.

Research Assistant

ESPOL Polytechnic University, 2019–2020

- Co-authored peer-reviewed publications and policy outputs.
- Produced economic bulletins on Asia-Pacific economies.
- Organised academic workshops and seminars.

PUBLICATIONS

- Displaced from the Ocean: New Realities of Small-Scale Fisheries and the Surge of Illicit Economies in Ecuador. [Forthcoming: Too Big To Ignore - TBTI Ebook Series] (*joint with C. Paez, C. Viteri*)
- Artisanal fisheries provide essential food and nutrition on the Galapagos Islands (*joint with C. Viteri, S. Partelow, L. Kluger, M. Tanner, O. Estes, G. Rodriguez, M.J. Barragan*) **Frontiers in Sustainable Food Systems**, 2026
- Dynamism of the housing rental market in Guayaquil (*joint with M. Zambrano-Monserrate, M. A. Ruano, R. Campoverde*) **Empirical Economics**, 2022
- Urban green spaces and housing prices in developing countries: A Two-stage quantile spatial regression analysis. (*joint with M. Zambrano-Monserrate, M. Ruano, C. Yoong*) **Forest Policy and Economics**, 2021
- The economic value of Natural Protected Areas in Ecuador (*joint with M. Zambrano-Monserrate, M. Ruano*) **Ocean and Coastal Management**, 2018
- Testing environmental Kuznets curve hypothesis in Peru: The role of renewable electricity, petroleum and dry natural gas (*joint with Zambrano-Monserrate, M., J. Davalos, A. Zambrano, M. Ruano*) **Renewable and Sustainable Energy Reviews**, 2018

POLICY IMPACT

- Research informed the Galapagos National Park Directorate's monitoring of the impacts of increasing entrance fees on tourism demand.
- Technical advisor in the participatory redesign process of Galapagos Marine Reserve zoning.
- Technical advisor in the development of the Galapagos Fisheries Calendar 2023–2028.

WORKING PAPERS

- Public acceptability of entrance fees in protected areas: How does revenue allocation shift support before and after policy implementation? (*joint with C. Aravena, E. McLaughlin*) [PhD Paper](#)
- The Effect of Temporary Alcohol Bans on Domestic Violence, Road Safety and Health (*joint with Javid Karimli*) [PhD Paper](#)
- Net benefits of stricter conservation policies in the Galapagos Marine Reserve (*joint with C. Viteri, A. Martinez-Cruz, C. Aravena*)

POLICY BRIEFS AND REPORTS

- One year after the adjustment of Galapagos entrance fees: Are there changes in tourist demand? [Policy Brief] Heriot-Watt University, Charles Darwin Foundation, December 2025 [PDF](#)

- Adjustment of entry fees to the Galapagos National Park – Tourist attitudes and perceptions [Policy Brief] Heriot-Watt University, Charles Darwin Foundation, March 2025 [PDF](#)
- Ecosystem Accounts for the Insular Economic Exclusive Zone of Ecuador [Technical Report No. 1] Charles Darwin Foundation. Puerto Ayora, Galápagos, Ecuador, 2025 [PDF](#)

GRANTS

Rufford Small Grant for Nature Conservation (£6000), 2024–2025

Principal Investigator responsible for project design, interdisciplinary collaboration, stakeholder engagement, field implementation and project management. Project: "Hidden Barriers to Conservation: Addressing Social Acceptability to Enhance Marine Reserve Management" [Project page](#)

CONFERENCES PRESENTATIONS

- Public acceptability of entrance fees in protected areas. World Congress of Environmental and Resource Economists (WCERE), 2026.
- Public support for environmental policies. EAERE Winter School, 2026.
- Displaced from the Ocean: New Realities of Small-Scale Fisheries and the Surge of Illicit Economies in Ecuador. World Small-scale Fisheries Congress, 2026.
- Revenue reallocation increases support for conservation entrance fees: Evidence before and after a fee change. Latin American Association of Environmental and Resource Economists Congress, 2025.
- Red-MOPTO: Integrating socio-economic research for the conservation of the ETP Marine Corridor. United Nations Ocean Decade Conference, 2024.

REFEREE SERVICE

- Journal of Environmental Studies and Sciences
- Antropología: Cuadernos de Investigación

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Research methods: stated preference valuation, survey design, impact evaluation, differences-in-differences, qualitative analysis. Software: R, Stata, QGIS
Teaching Technologies: Blackboard Zoom; Canvas

LANGUAGES

Spanish (native), English (fluent).

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

- Latin American Association of Environmental and Resource Economists (LAERE)
- European Association of Environmental and Resource Economists (EAERE)
- Scottish Graduate Economists Program (SGPE) and Scottish Economic Society
- Small Scale Fisheries Network - Too Big to Ignore (TBTI) Global
- United Nations - Early Career Ocean Professional (UN-ECOP)

REFERENCES

Name: Claudia Aravena

Position: Associate Professor

Institution: Heriot-Watt University

Contact: Available upon request

Name: Eoin McLaughlin

Position: Professor

Institution: Heriot-Watt University

Contact: Available upon request

Name: Richard Damania

Position: Chief Economist of the Sustainable Development Practice Group

Institution: World Bank

Contact: Available upon request